MARIANA MARTINS MENEZES

Frontend & Design Engineer

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Melbourne, VIC, open to relocating within Australia | NZ Citizen, Full Unrestricted Australian Work Rights

SUMMARY

Frontend & Design engineer with five years of professional React and TypeScript experience building accessible, high-performance product interfaces, with a UI/UX design background and hands-on Next.js experience. Has shipped to a global HR platform, an enterprise analytics product, and a high-traffic retail platform on Magento 2 serving three markets. Contributed to an accessibility team auditing components platform-wide for WCAG 2.1 AA, led the frontend side of a company-wide design system build, and built a three-tier design token architecture automated end to end with Style Dictionary. Treats accessibility, motion and interaction states as part of the component rather than a later pass. Uses AI-assisted development daily (Claude Code, Cursor) while owning architecture and the quality of what ships. Fully remote since 2021.

SKILLS

Frontend Engineering: React, TypeScript, JavaScript (ES6+), HTML5, CSS3, Next.js, responsive design, web standards and browser-native APIs, REST and GraphQL, state management, Zod

Design Systems: Design tokens (primitive/semantic/component), Style Dictionary, Radix UI Primitives, Storybook, Atomic Design, component APIs

Accessibility & Quality: WCAG 2.1 AA+, ARIA, manual screen reader and keyboard testing, focus management, Axe, jest-axe, Jest, React Testing Library, Cypress, MSW

Design & Styling: Figma, Penpot, UI/UX and interaction design, prototyping, Motion, Tailwind CSS, CSS-in-JS, Sass, Less, CSS Modules, Material UI

AI Tools: Claude Code (daily), Cursor, Google Antigravity IDE, Gemini, with output reviewed before it ships

Platforms & Delivery: Magento 2 (enterprise e-commerce), Git and GitHub, GitLab CI/CD, AWS, Sentry, Datadog, technical documentation, code review, Jira, Agile (Scrum, Scrumban, Kanban)

EXPERIENCE

Independent Product & Design Systems Work

May 2024 – Present | Melbourne, VIC

Stack: Next.js, React, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS, TanStack Query, Zod, Style Dictionary, Radix UI, Jest, jest-axe, Vite, Motion

- Designed and built FitMySpace end to end, from problem framing and visual design in Penpot and Figma through to production implementation (Next.js, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS, TanStack Query, Zod), owning both the product decisions and the code.
- Built a complete three-tier design token architecture (primitive, semantic, component) with Style Dictionary, automating the pipeline from token definition to platform-ready output, following Brad Frost's methodology.
- Composed custom components on top of Radix UI headless primitives rather than adopting a generic component library, so semantics, interaction states, dark mode and motion stay owned and consistent across the system.
- Separately, designed and built a personal portfolio site (React 19, TypeScript, Vite, Motion) with dark/light theming, motion and interaction detail, and full accessibility testing. Code is public on GitHub.
- Work daily with AI-assisted development (Claude Code, Cursor, Google Antigravity IDE, Gemini) to prototype and explore, while directing the architecture and reviewing generated output rather than accepting it as final.
- I stepped back from full-time work in May 2024 and relocated from New Zealand to Australia in March 2026, working on the projects above through that period.

Remote (Remote.com) — Frontend Engineer

July 2021 – April 2024 | Remote position

Stack: React, TypeScript, Next.js, TanStack Query, REST APIs, Styled Components, Jest, React Testing Library, Cypress, GitLab CI/CD, Sentry, Datadog

- Built core product surfaces for a global HR and Employer of Record platform, including legislation-aware onboarding flows used across multiple countries.
- Translated Figma designs into production React and Storybook components, working directly with product designers on interaction and usability decisions rather than receiving finished specs.

- Identified a set of unaddressed UX pain points across the product, framed the opportunity and proposed an initiative to fix them, then partnered with a product designer to deliver it: an informal programme we ran as "UX Wins", working through non-responsive elements, accessibility gaps and workflow frictions users had complained about for a long time.
- Built and documented reusable components for the team's shared Design System so product teams could ship cohesive, on-system experiences instead of one-off solutions.
- Contributed as a member of the Accessibility (A11y) team, auditing and upgrading components platform-wide for WCAG 2.1 compliance, testing with screen readers and the keyboard rather than relying on automated tooling alone, and partnering with designers on code-level fixes.
- Modernised legacy onboarding forms by migrating them from Formik to a JSON Schema-driven architecture, working directly with backend engineers on where validation logic should live, and designing the validation, error and empty states users actually hit along the way.
- Worked fully async across time zones: documented decisions in Notion, created and prioritised my own tickets, deployed to production, and investigated frontend incidents in Sentry and Datadog.

Phocas Software — Frontend Developer *January 2021 – June 2021 | Christchurch, NZ*

Stack: React, TypeScript, GraphQL (Apollo), Redux, MobX, Material UI, CSS-in-JS, Mocha

- Promoted from Junior Frontend Developer after ten months, on the strength of the interface and user experience work I led on the company's new flagship product.
- Led the frontend side of a months-long initiative to build the company's first comprehensive Design System alongside the lead designer, with other developers and designers contributing under our direction: deciding which components to rebuild and in what order, how each should be structured, and how to keep the system coherent as it grew.
- Acted as the bridge between design and engineering on the flagship product, designing UI components in Figma and architecting their implementation in code.

Phocas Software — Junior Frontend Developer *March 2020 – January 2021 | Christchurch, NZ*

Stack: React, TypeScript, GraphQL (Apollo), Redux, MobX, Material UI, CSS-in-JS, Mocha

- Helped build a brand-new flagship product (Budgeting & Forecasting) from the ground up, developing reusable React components from scratch alongside the team.
- Led frontend user experience and layout decisions for the module, pairing closely with the product designer and design lead, and presenting the resulting interface directly to the company's founders.
- Contributed to a comprehensive testing suite that measurably reduced production defects.

Kathmandu — Junior Frontend Developer *October 2018 – March 2020 | Christchurch, NZ*

Stack: Magento 2, JavaScript, Less, Jasmine, responsive e-commerce templates

- Translated high-fidelity Figma designs into polished, brand-consistent, responsive consumer e-commerce interfaces on Magento 2, for a high-traffic AU/UK/NZ retail platform.
- Worked across the front end with JavaScript, Less and Jasmine tests in a large, established Magento codebase, with regular exposure to the platform's PHP backend and small backend changes where a task required them.

Chingu — Frontend Developer *December 2017 – January 2018 | Remote position*

- Built a responsive web application for a non-profit (Husky Rescue) using React and Sass as part of a remote, cross-functional cohort team.

EDUCATION & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Subatomic: The Complete Guide to Design Tokens — Brad Frost Web | 2026
AI and Design Systems — Brad Frost Web | 2026 (in progress)
CSS for JavaScript Developers & The Joy of React — Josh Comeau | 2025
Foundations of User Experience (UX) Design — Google (Coursera) | 2021
UI/UX Design Specialization — California Institute of the Arts (Coursera) | 2020
React, Redux and React Native Nano-Degree — Udacity | 2020
Bachelor's Degree in History — Universidade Federal Fluminense, Brazil | 2009–2014